

HELICOPTERS

The helicopter has been a major force in transforming warfare on the modern battlefield. Transport helicopters – such as the CH-47 Chinook and the UH-60 Black Hawk – are able to deliver heavy stores to forward troops, and having no need for a runway they can do this in almost any type of terrain. More important still has been the introduction of the attack helicopter, or “helicopter gunship”, which provides close air support to ground troops and targets enemy armour. The Russian MI-24 Hind is a rare hybrid – a gunship that doubles up as a troop carrier.

▼ BELL UH-1 IROQUOIS

Date	1959	Origin	US
Rotor span	14.63m (48ft)		
Length	17.4m (57ft)		
Top speed	217kph (135mph)		
Engine	820kW (1,100hp) Lycoming T53-L-11 turboshaft		

The UH-1 “Huey” – which first saw service during the Vietnam War – was a workhorse of the US Army, operating in many roles, including gunship, troop transport, search and rescue, liaison, and casualty evacuation.

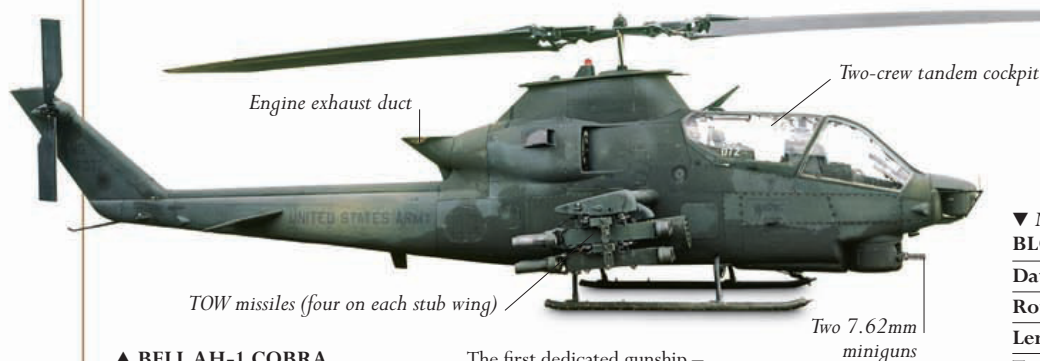


Hydraulic power units and tanks (cover open)

► BOEING VERTOL CH-47 CHINOOK

Date	1962	Origin	US
Rotor span	18.3m (60ft) each		
Length	30.2m (99ft)		
Top speed	315kph (196mph)		
Engine	Two 2,796kW (3,750hp) Lycoming T55-GA-712 turboshafts		

The twin-rotor CH-47 has been one of the longest-serving and most effective of cargo-carrying helicopters. Large loads can be slung underneath the helicopter, and a wide loading ramp is situated at the rear.



▲ BELL AH-1 COBRA

Date	1967	Origin	US
Rotor span	13.6m (44ft)		
Length	16.1m (52.3ft)		
Top speed	315kph (196mph)		
Engine	1,300kW (1,800hp) Lycoming T53-L-703 turboshaft		

The first dedicated gunship – with a fighter-style two-man cockpit – the AH-1 Cobra proved highly effective in Vietnam, providing close fire support to slower and more vulnerable helicopters such as the UH-1.

▼ MESSERSCHMITT-BÖLKOW-BLOHM BO-105

Date	1971	Origin	West Germany
Rotor span	9.84m (32½ft)		
Length	11.86m (39ft)		
Top speed	270kph (167mph)		
Engine	Two 313kW (420hp) Allison 250-C20B turboshafts		

The BO-105 was the first helicopter to offer the safety provided by twin engines. Its low weight and agile performance were combined with a potent punch provided by six HOT (High subsonic Optical remote-guided fired from Tube) anti-tank missiles.

